Day 46 - Petun, John Haigh, Black Ash Creek

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Blue Mountains section · hike 55 · Petun Conservation Area

11.3 km / 7.0 mi	~3.4 h	6.9 km new	110 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): A small parking area on the east side of 2nd Line provided by the Nottawasaga Valley Conservation Area. Google Maps. **Paid: $15 + HST per vehicle (day)** · scan QR code on site signs or HotSpot app/website; NVCA requires a parking pass at its conservation areas (except Tottenham, New Lowell); this small lot not named specifically; annual pass $70

Navigate: import *day46_hike055.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Petun Side Trail (4.1 km); John Haigh Side Trail (2.5 km); Black Ash Creek Side Trail (0.3 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** A small NVCA lot on the east side of 2nd Line. A directory listing for Petun Conservation Area (675485 2nd Line) shows parking as paid, so check the NVCA site for current fees.
- **Petun area:** The conservation area sits at one of the highest elevations on the Niagara Escarpment. Here the Bruce Trail winds through rock faces, cliffs and crevices. Keep Zappy on a short leash near the edges.
- **John Haigh Side Trail:** Follows the 2nd Line road allowance and passes the highest point on the entire Bruce Trail. Parts run on the road shoulder, so keep the dog close.
- **Petun Side Trail:** The longest leg of the hike. It includes a road-shoulder stretch, where the dog should stay close. No further description was found.
- **Black Ash Creek Side Trail:** A short access trail from the parking area. No details were found.
- **Plants and phones:** Watch for poison ivy and giant hogweed. Cell service is unreliable in parts of The Blue Mountains.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

> **Can't do it all in one go?** Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 8.2 km / 5.1 mi, covering Black Ash Creek, Petun. **Outing 2** from the planned parking (P) again: 6.6 km / 4.1 mi, covering John Haigh. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions

0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: A small parking area on the east side of 2nd Line provided by the Nottawasaga Valley…. Head south on the blue-blazed Black Ash Creek Side Trail.
0.3	0.2	J1: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.4	0.9	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Petun Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
3.5	2.2	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.0	2.5	Heads-up: The next 2.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.2	2.6	J3: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Petun Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.5	3.4	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed John Haigh Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
8.0	5.0	J5: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
9.7	6.0	Heads-up: The next 0.8 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.5	6.5	J4: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the Petun Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
10.9	6.8	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Black Ash Creek Side Trail, heading north-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
11.3	7.0	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Conservation Areas, Ontario Nature Trails and the Town of The Blue Mountains trail map.